LARC

#19STRONG. COMMUNITY & COLLEGES TRANSFORMING FUTURES.



Human Intelligence Festival

HIRING HUMANS

November 6, 2026 · **MAGIC BOX**, Downtown Los Angeles · Presented by LARC

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Human Intelligence Festival

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WHO IS LARC?

The Los Angeles Regional Consortium

19 colleges. 11 districts. One, connected LA Region.

LARC links K-16 education partners, and employers to build career pathways and expand economic opportunity across Los Angeles—and through our students, far beyond it. Our AI Taskforce and Student Cohort bring educators, industry, and students together to shape human-centered approaches to AI, learning, and work.

Cerritos College
LAHC Los Angeles Harbor College
elac
Compton College
LAVC Los Angeles Valley College
Long Beach City College
El Camino College
LASC
LATTC Los Angeles Trade-Tech A Community College
Los Angeles Pierce College
West LA College
Santa Monica College
Mt. SAC Mt. San Antonio College
Río Hondo College
Pasadena City College
LACC Los Angeles City College The City's College.
Los Angeles Mission College
Glendale Community College
Citrus College

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Time	Session
8:00	**Registration Opens**
9:00–9:20	**Welcome**
9:20–10:00	**Festival Catalyst (Keynote)**
10-Minute Break	
10:10–10:55	**Recognizing Capability: What Employers Need to See and Hear** Employer Panel
10-Minute Break	
11:05–11:50	**Festival & Optional Breakout Sessions** • Breakout: Beyond Copy-Paste - Keeping Human Thinking at the Center of AI • Breakout: Let's Keep it Real…Real Human • Breakout: The Hiring Room • Breakout: Who Would You Hire • Breakout: AI Speed Dating • Breakout: AI Fluency & Innovation Regional Project Facutly • Festival Games • Visit the Vendors
10-Minute Break	
12:00–12:50	**Lunch** Hall A (Main Room)
10-Minute Break	
1:00–1:45	**Fostering Human Agency: How to Teach, Evaluate, and Articulate Student Value** Faculty Panel
10-Minute Break	
1:55–2:40	**From Classroom to Career Experience: The Human Edge in Action** Fireside Chat: Student Perspectives
2:40–3:00	**Humans Have the Last Word**
3:00–3:30	**Celebrate the Wins + Closing**

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Welcome from LARC Chair



Dr. Narineh Makijan
Chair & Assistant Vice President
Los Angeles Regional Consortium

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Dr. Narineh Makijan is a transformational leader, author, and educator with 20+ years of experience advancing counseling, workforce development, and Career & Technical Education. She serves as Assistant Vice President and Chair of the Los Angeles Regional Consortium (LARC), hosted by Pasadena City College, where she leads regional ecosystem development across 19 community colleges in Los Angeles County, coordinating cross-sector partnerships to deliver data-informed, technology-enabled pathways that close equity gaps and expand upward mobility.

Dr. Makijan is the author of *Beyond the Algorithm: Human-Centered AI*, a practical guide for student services professionals and counselors across K–16 education, and Sophia's Garden of Virtues, a children's book focused on character development and values. A faculty member at USC Rossier School of Education, she teaches in the M.Ed. School Counseling/PPS program and champions early college, dual enrollment, and end-to-end CTE pathways that connect education systems with employers and emerging industries.

Dr. Makijan serves on state and local boards focused on workforce innovation and education transformation. Her vision is bold and human-centered: build coordinated systems that empower learners to discover purpose, gain real-world experience, and thrive in a rapidly evolving, tech-driven future.

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Meet the Festival Catalyst



Sean Allen
Festival Catalyst
Engineer | Entrepreneur | AI & Leadership
Argos Engineers

ARGOS

Sean Allen is the Chief Operating Officer of Argos Engineers, a civil engineer, entrepreneur, certified Project Management Professional (PMP), and leader known as “The Real Goalsetter.” With more than 15 years of experience leading engineering projects, business initiatives, and organizational transformations, Sean brings a unique perspective on the intersection of human intelligence, artificial intelligence, and the future of work.

Sean is passionate about helping organizations harness emerging technologies while preserving the distinctly human capabilities that drive success: critical thinking, creativity, emotional intelligence, ethical judgment, and leadership. He believes AI should not replace human potential but amplify it, empowering individuals to make better decisions, solve complex problems, and create meaningful value.

Sean has also developed an interdisciplinary internship program integrating AI into engineering, business, and marketing, helping students gain practical experience and prepare for evolving career opportunities.

His message is clear: Technology may transform how we work, but human intelligence, adaptability, and the ability to turn ideas into action will define how we succeed.

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FACULTY PANEL | MEET THE EDUCATORS

Fostering Human Agency: How to Teach, Evaluate, and Articulate Student Value

 **Dr. Vincent Calip** **Faculty Panel Moderator** *Professor, Computer and Office Studies* **Long Beach City College**	Dr. Vincent Calip is a Professor at Long Beach City College, facilitating instruction on Artificial Intelligence, and improving student learning with emerging technologies. He is an ardent supporter of using AI in higher education, and he collaborates closely with other educational practitioners and administrative leadership to investigate this technology's opportunities in pedagogy. He has authored one of the first AI Degrees in the California Community College System, and the only one in the Los Angeles region. Dr. Calip also serves as the faculty lead for the AI Literacy & Fluency Innovation SWP regional projects led by LBCC. Professor Calip is passionate about student success, and improving equity in higher education.
 **Janet Mitchell Lambert** **Faculty Panel Moderator** *Lead DE Coordinator* *Professor, English* **Cerritos College** **@ONE Facilitator** **CCCCO AI Fellow**	Janet Mitchell Lambert began teaching in 1993 after graduating from UCLA. With Master's degrees in TESOL and English, she has taught at the community college level since 2002. As an English professor and Lead Distance Education Coordinator at Cerritos College, she helped launch CerritosOnline in 2025 and teaches professional development courses through @ONE. A California Community Colleges AI Fellow, Janet is passionate about humanizing education, cultivating authentic student voice, and empowering faculty and students to navigate AI thoughtfully while preserving the critical thinking, creativity, and human connection essential to learning.
 **Dr. Terri Horton MBA, MA, SHRM-CP** *Work Futurist* *AI & Future of Work Advisor* *Speaker and Lecturer* **FuturePath, LLC**	Dr. Terri Horton is a globally recognized work futurist and founder of FuturePath, advising Fortune 500 companies and universities on AI-driven workforce transformation and human- centered leadership. Her insights have been featured by Forbes, EY, Google, and Pew Research Center. She serves on advisory councils for Harvard Business Review and Microsoft. Her LinkedIn Learning courses have reached 450,000+ learners worldwide, with content included in Microsoft's Global AI Skills Initiative. She holds a doctorate in Organizational Change and Leadership from USC and teaches in the University of California and California State University systems.

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FACULTY PANEL | MEET THE EDUCATORS (CONTINUED)

Fostering Human Agency: How to Teach, Evaluate, and Articulate Student Value

 **Dr. Tahir Aziz** *Professor, Computer and Office Studies* **Long Beach City College**	Dr. Terri Horton is a globally recognized work futurist and founder of FuturePath, advising Fortune 500 companies and universities on AI-driven workforce transformation and human- centered leadership. Her insights have been featured by Forbes, EY, Google, and Pew Research Center. She serves on advisory councils for Harvard Business Review and Microsoft. Her LinkedIn Learning courses have reached 450,000+ learners worldwide, with content included in Microsoft's Global AI Skills Initiative. She holds a doctorate in Organizational Change and Leadership from USC and teaches in the University of California and California State University systems.
 **Taraquinn Curry** *CEO at Quinnsight Teacher* ***Long Beach USD*** **California State AI Task Force Member**	Dr. Terri Horton is a globally recognized work futurist and founder of FuturePath, advising Fortune 500 companies and universities on AI-driven workforce transformation and human- centered leadership. Her insights have been featured by Forbes, EY, Google, and Pew Research Center. She serves on advisory councils for Harvard Business Review and Microsoft. Her LinkedIn Learning courses have reached 450,000+ learners worldwide, with content included in Microsoft's Global AI Skills Initiative. She holds a doctorate in Organizational Change and Leadership from USC and teaches in the University of California and California State University systems.

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EMPLOYER PANEL | MEET THE EMPLOYERS

Recognizing Capability: What Employers Need to See and Hear

 **John Baker: Employer Panel Moderator** *Employer Partnership Coordinator* **Los Angeles Regional Consortium**	John serves as the Employer Partnership Coordinator (EPC) in ICT/Digital Media for LARC, connecting employers with LARC's 19 community colleges, building partnerships that align programs with workforce needs, and creating pathways to jobs and work-based learning. Over the breadth of his career he has been able to accrue a multi-faceted degree of leadership and management assets from developing and managing major rock bands to developing wave energy projects. He continues to assist diverse and emerging businesses with their new or existing verticals.
 **Momin "Mo" Raees** *Founder & Managing Partner* **Ally Technologies**	Momin is the founder and managing partner of Ally Technologies, a company built to bring a more human, customer-first approach to serving some of the world's leading commercial and enterprise organizations. He believes lasting success comes from building trust, genuine relationships, and meaningful outcomes. As AI continues to evolve, Momin remains focused on what matters most: people want to do business with people. Before founding Ally Technologies, he held roles at Dell Technologies and Hewlett Packard Enterprise.
 **Eric Kim** *General Manager, US AI, 3D, Partnerships & Market Expansion* **Tripo AI, Tripo Studio by VAST**	Eric is a business and operations leader focused on creator ecosystems, consumer platforms, AI, and market expansion. At Tripo Studio, he leads market development, partnerships, operations, and go-to-market strategy, translating the global product vision into adoption and growth. He builds strategic relationships and champions a creator-first approach to new technology, helping creators tell their stories and communities thrive. Previously, Eric served as Senior Director of Operations at BIGO, where he helped grow core live-streaming business units across agency management, broadcaster engagement, user retention, and revenue strategy.
 **Dr. Renah Wolzinger** *Technical Director* **Eduvators**	Renah is an OpenAI Featured Faculty member, award-winning innovator and composer, and 2025 EdTech Awards Trendsetter. She is Technical Director at Eduvators and former Chief Academic Officer at EON Reality, where she pioneered integrating emerging technologies into education. With more than 20 years of experience in California's community colleges, she specializes in scalable, data-informed learning solutions. A long time Recording Academy voting member, Dr. Wolzinger composes for independent film and digital media. She is a global keynote speaker on AI in education and Board Chair Emeritus of Vital Link, championing workforce development and educational transformation.

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EMPLOYER PANEL | MEET THE EMPLOYERS (CONTINUED)

Recognizing Capability: What Employers Need to See and Hear

 **Craig Russon** *Account Executive, Academic* **CompTIA**	Craig Russon brings more than 25 years of experience working with academic institutions to support IT, cybersecurity, and computer literacy education. He partners with institutions to strengthen academic programs and foster student success across traditional, hybrid, and online learning environments, leveraging technology to create engaging and effective educational experiences.
 **Mariana Acuña Acosta** *Vice President, AI Native Productions* **Fox Entertainment**	Mariana's career has spanned VFX, VR, Virtual Production and AI, always at the intersection of technology, software development, pipelines and production innovation across film, episodic, animation and advertising. She's worked as a VFX Supervisor, Technical Director, Head of Technology and Chief Product Officer, among other roles. Along the way, she co-developed the CaraVR plugin for Nuke, built an off-the-shelf virtual camera system, and unified six different pipelines through Unreal Engine at Technicolor. Before joining Fox, she designed and implemented AI-native workflows for episodic and animation at an AI Native Studio. At FoxNXT, she leads the R&D efforts to turn emerging technologies into production-ready systems that can scale and meet the practical realities of content production across different types of projects.

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FIRESIDE CHAT: STUDENT PERSPECTIVES

From Classroom to Career Experience: The Human Edge in Action

 **Pryce Phungsakrakiat** **Moderator** *Business/Economics Major* **Cerritos College**	Pryce Phungraksakiat is a sophomore at Cerritos College studying Business Administration and Economics. He is LARC's AI Cohort Student Lead and a Student Member of the California Community Colleges Chancellor's Office AI Council. Through his finance internship at Ushio America and membership in OpenAI's ChatGPT Lab, he has explored how technology and human judgment will shape the future of work for current students. Pryce is passionate about helping community college students leverage classroom learning, student leadership, and personal projects into career opportunities. In his free time, he practices Japanese tea ceremony and hopes to train in Kyoto, Japan, next summer.
 **Kassidy Wang** *Physics* **Santa Monica College**	Kassidy Wang is a physics student at Santa Monica College with a bachelor's degree in English from UC Irvine. Her path into science follows several years working in logistics. In 2025, she conducted agricultural research through UC Riverside at the USDA Salinity Laboratory, using satellite imagery and Python to study crop health and estimate yields. She also participated in NASA's L'SPACE Mission Concept Academy, collaborating on a Mars mission concept. She brings experience moving between the humanities, working life, and technical research to the conversation about learning and preparing for a career alongside AI.
 **Elianna Nayelli Peña** *Trauma Studies* **Long Beach City College**	Elianna attends Long Beach City College, where she studies sociology, political science, and psychology. She is currently finishing her Associate of Science in Trauma Studies and plans to transfer to CSULB in the spring as a political science major. As a system-impacted youth who spent 13 years in the Los Angeles County child welfare system, Elianna now works with nonprofits to advocate for policy, legislation, and youth programming. She previously interned at the Superior Court and for Assemblymember Josh Lowenthal.
 **Jacob Padilla** *Mechanical Engineering* **Cerritos College**	Jacob Padilla is a sophomore at Cerritos College Studying Mechanical Engineering. He has conducted independent research in Taiwan at Providence University and professional research at UCR, both toward green infrastructure development. He is currently participating in the Caltech Aerospace Mentorship Program, where he continues to develop technical skills with mentorship and projects with Caltech Grad Students and Professors.

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OPTIONAL

30-Minute Breakout Sessions, Connect with Vendors, & Festival Room Fun

BREAKOUT SESSIONS: 30 MINUTES



Taraquinn Curry
CEO at Quinnsight
Teacher
Long Beach USD
California State AI Task Force Member

Beyond Copy-Paste: Keeping Human Thinking at the Center of AI

In this 30-minute session, educator and author Tarquinn Curry shares the philosophy behind his book, Beyond Copy-Paste: helping people think with AI while maintaining their ability to think for themselves. Through a live demonstration of his Chrome extension, he shows how teachers can create activities that make student thinking visible and strengthen judgment, creativity, and human collaboration. Participants will explore what this approach means for preparing learners for a workplace that values both AI skills and independent human judgment. *Refer to Faculty Panel for bio.*



Stephen Miller
Professor Emeritus
ENMU-Ruidoso, CAE Peer Review National Center (PRNC) Director

Let's Keep It Real...Real Human

In a world rapidly filling with AI-generated content, deep fakes, and automated influence, "keeping it real" has shifted from a casual social phrase to a critical survival strategy for our minds. As technology makes it easier to manipulate what we see, hear, and believe, maintaining our human element requires a new kind of defense: cognitive security.

Stephen Miller
Stephen D. Miller, M.S., is Professor Emeritus at ENMU-Ruidoso, Director of the CAE Peer Review National Center (PRNC), and an NSF ATE NCyTE Leadership Team consultant through Whatcom Community College. A Vietnam veteran and retired ExxonMobil Global Information Systems executive, he served on NASA Mission Control during the Apollo missions.Through NCyTE, he supports cybersecurity outreach to Native American tribes and colleges, industry engagement, curriculum and workforce development, and international DEI support for students. He led New Mexico's CTE CyberNet Academy for Mescalero High School teachers and has served on numerous grants, boards, and committees, including CAE committees of practice.

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OPTIONAL (CONTINUED)

30-Minute Breakout Sessions, Connect with Vendors, & Festival Room Fun

Breakout **GET READY FOR READY ROOM**	**Get Ready for Ready Room** A welcoming place to practice before the real opportunity. Join educators and employers for a short, supportive mock interview built around familiar questions about your education, experiences, and use of AI. Get helpful feedback, build confidence, and leave ready to show what you bring. All are welcome to participate.
 LARC #19STRONG. COMMUNITY & COLLEGES TRANSFORMING FUTURES. **Judy Fox** *Program Manager and AI Taskforce/Student AI Cohort Co-Lead* **Los Angeles Regional Consortium**	**Who Gets Hired?** If every candidate has the same polished, AI-ready résumé, what sets them apart? This fast-paced, science-informed, digital game tests 13 human strengths in real-world work scenarios—from judgment and ethics to creativity and focus. Compete for the top leaderboard score and discover your Human Edge profile. Who will get hired? This is a prize opportunity. Must have a digital device to play. **Judy Fox** Judy is a Program Manager and AI Taskforce/Student Cohort Co-Lead with LARC, where she supports consortium operations and the success of Strong Workforce Program regional projects while advancing human-centered AI learning and student engagement.
 **Dr. Par Mohammadian** *Life Sciences Vice Chair* **Los Angeles Mission College** **CCCCO AI Fellow**	**AI Speed Dating (Located in the Festival Room)** Interested in connecting with like-minded peers who use AI? Join AI Speed Dating to meet colleagues, exchange ideas, and explore opportunities to collaborate.

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OPTIONAL (CONTINUED)

30-Minute Breakout Sessions, Connect with Vendors, & Festival Room Fun

Led by
Long Beach City College

AI Literacy/Fluency & Innovation Projects Meet-Up (Upstairs coffee shop area)

This breakout session is for faculty members of the Rounds 10 and 11 SWP Regional Projects: AI Literacy & Innovation and AI Fluency & Innovation. Led by Long Beach City College, it's an opportunity to meet face-to-face, get to know your colleagues from across the region, and connect around the work happening on your campuses. Share experiences, exchange ideas, and explore ways to learn from one another as you advance AI learning and integration.

CONNECT WITH VENDORS

ALLY TECHNOLOGIES

Joined by intel + Lenovo



Momin "Mo" Raees
Founder & Managing Partner
Ally Technologies

Visit Ally Technologies

Ally Technologies helps organizations build secure, reliable technology environments through IT infrastructure, cloud strategy, cybersecurity, and hardware and software implementation. You can't manage what you can't see. By helping clients understand how their systems perform, where risks lie, and what solutions cost, Ally supports more informed technology decisions. Clear information leads to better decisions. Whether modernizing an existing environment or planning a new one, Ally Technologies brings the right technical and commercial expertise to the table. Link to website. These technologies are also shaping today's classrooms and workplaces. Ally's expertise highlights why students benefit from developing digital fluency and understanding the systems that will support the careers of the future. ***Connect with Momin Raees.*** *Read his bio in the Employer Panel bio section.*

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OPTIONAL (CONTINUED)

30-Minute Breakout Sessions, Connect with Vendors, & Festival Room Fun

CONNECT WITH VENDORS

NCyTE CENTER



Michele Robinson
Senior Director
NCyTE Center

Visit National Cybersecurity Training & Education Center (NCyTE)

NCyTE is a national research center with the goal of increasing the quantity and quality of the cybersecurity workforce in the United States. These goals are being accomplished through innovative curriculum development; building an online community for faculty professional growth and mentoring; creating a developmental pathway of competitions that facilitate growth of students' cybersecurity skills; and facilitating processes at the state and national level conducive to development of cybersecurity programs. With resources available to faculty, career seekers, and industry, you are invited to visit the website to learn more. Link to website.

Connect with Michele Robinson

Michele serves as Senior Director/Principal Investigator (PI) of the National Cyber Training and Education (NCyTE) Center and the CAE Candidates National Center (CCNC), both hosted at Whatcom Community College. A cybersecurity and public policy leader, she previously served as Director of the California Office of Information Security (OIS) and State Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) appointed by Gov. Jerry Brown. Her other roles included OIS Chief, Security Risk Governance Branch; OIS Deputy CISO and Statewide Incident Management Program Manager; CISO and Privacy Officer for the California Unemployment Insurance Appeals Board; and technical and managerial positions with the California Department of Consumer Affairs. She holds CISSP, CISM, CISA, and CDPSE certifications.

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30-Minute Breakout Sessions, Connect with Vendors, & Festival Room Fun

CONNECT WITH VENDORS

AFTERSchool.org



Manuel Zavala
K-12 Educator
Founder
Afterschool.org & Student Hires

Visit Afterschool.org

Afterschool.org connects families, educators, businesses, and community leaders with resources and partnerships that support students beyond the classroom. Its hub brings together academic support, career development, mental health resources, and tools for collaboration—helping communities turn afterschool hours into opportunities for learning, discovery, and growth. Link to website.

Student Hires was founded with one mission in mind: to connect students with valuable job opportunities. We do this throughout all of our work. In all of our programs, we hire local college & university students. They serve as the foundation for our workforce, allowing these students to gain valuable job experience that can transform their entire career outlook. Given that Student Hires is currently offering expanded learning programs led by local college & university students, every program that we create is the creation of the compounding value of opportunity for the disadvantaged communities that we serve. It takes one opportunity to transform the outlook for a career and for an entire family as well. Link to website.

Connect with Manuel Zavala

Manuel is an education entrepreneur and former Career Technical Education computer science teacher. He founded Student Hires to connect K–12 schools with college students who lead engaging after-school programs—creating learning opportunities for younger students and meaningful work experience for near-peer mentors. In 2023, he launched Afterschool.org, a resource hub that connects families, educators, and communities with enrichment opportunities.

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OPTIONAL (CONTINUED)

30-Minute Breakout Sessions, Connect with Vendors, & Festival Room Fun

FESTIVAL FUN: Every game turns into a hiring skill to enjoy.

HUMAN IMPACT (Strength Bell) 	**How well do you know your own strength?** Set a target and see how close you land. Impact starts with confidence and self-awareness.
 **FIRST-HAND SKILLS (Ring Toss)**	**You hold what counts.** AI can help produce the work; your ideas, judgment, and decisions give it purpose.
 **NETWORKING: HAVE FUN EXPANDING HUMAN CONNECTIONS**	**Goal: Meet three new people—including someone whose role or perspective differs from yours, including vendors!** Start with a simple question: **"What brings you to Hiring Humans?"** Share what you do, discover a common interest, and explore how you might learn from or support one another. Exchange contact information and identify a reason to follow up—a shared resource, an introduction, or a possible collaboration.
 **TAKE YOUR SHOT (Basketball)**	**How many can you sink?** Taking more shots helps. Learning from the misses helps more. Same goes for your next application or innovation.

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THE GOAL

The experts are all here. The goal is to help employers recognize human capability, K16 educators develop it, and students demonstrate it, in a world of hiring and learning shaped by AI.

PARTICIPANTS SHOULD LEAVE BETTER ABLE TO:

- **Evaluate:** Spot critical thinking, creativity, ethics, and judgment beneath polished AI-assisted work, and design hiring practices that bring those qualities to the surface.
- **Develop:** Turn what employers value into learning students can practice and develop.
- **Demonstrate:** Show their thinking, explain their decisions, audit what AI produces, and take responsibility for the result.
- **Act:** Walk away with one concrete shift in how they hire, teach, apply, or prepare.

The result: practice sharpened by distinctly human judgment.

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SPECIAL THANKS TO THE FESTIVAL PLANNING TEAM & STUDENT CREW

Planning Team

Dr. Vincent Calip, Long Beach City College
Kevin Fernandez, LARC
Judy Fox, LARC
Dr. Narineh Makijan, LARC
Dr. Parvaneh Mohammadian, LA Mission College
Mario Perez, LA Valley College
Pryce Phungraksakia, Cerritos College
Noushig Simonian, LARC

Student Crew

Sebastian Corleto, Rio Hondo College
Ramon Emmons, LAUSD/Dual Enrolled
Michael Flores, Jr., LA Pierce College
Esmeralda Lopez, East LA College
Angel Rodriguez, LA Valley College
Alex Rupasov, LA Valley College

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THANK YOU!

Dr. Narineh Makijan, Chair & Assistant VP, LARC · nmakijan@pasadena.edu

Schedule and activities are subject to adjustment.